City of Contrasts

AP Human Geography · Unit 6 · Two stimuli (like Question 3) · 7 points · Student handout · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

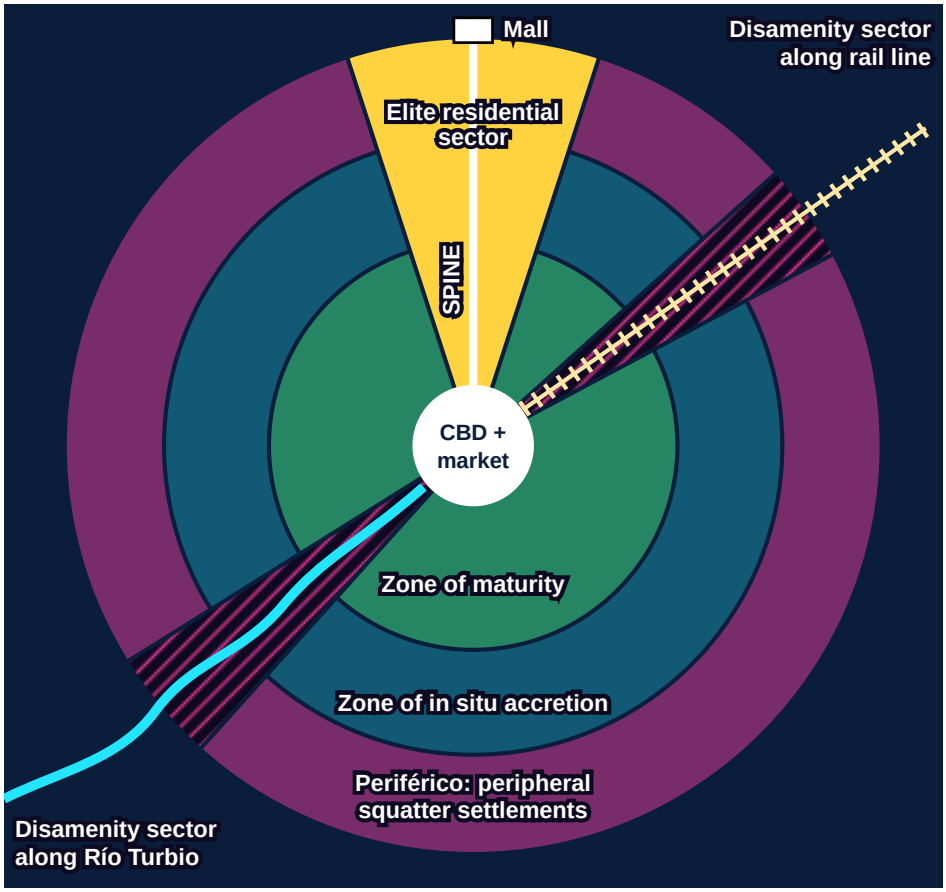
Name _____ Date _____ Period _____

Directions: Answer all parts of the question. Respond in complete sentences; an outline or bulleted list is not acceptable. Label each part (A, B, C...). For Describe and Explain parts, write it out with **T1-** (your reason in general words), **E2-** (the specific proof), and **A3-** (why it matters).

Puerto Alba is the largest city of Valdoria, an invented Latin American country. Like many cities in developing countries, it has grown fast as people pour in from the countryside, and its rich and poor neighborhoods are arranged very differently from a typical U.S. city's.

Stimulus 1: Model of Puerto Alba, a Fictional Latin American City · Stimulus 2: The Four Largest Cities of Valdoria, 2000 and 2025

Stimulus 1: Model of Puerto Alba, a Fictional Latin American City



CBD & market · Spine & elite residential sector · Zone of maturity · Zone of in situ accretion · Periférico (squatter settlements) · Disamenity sector · River · Rail line

Created for practice, based on the Griffin-Ford model. Puerto Alba and the Río Turbio are fictional. Not to scale.

Stimulus 2: The Four Largest Cities of Valdoria, 2000 and 2025

Rank	City	Population, 2000	Population, 2025	Rank-size rule prediction, 2025 (largest ÷ rank)
1	Puerto Alba	5,400,000	9,600,000	9,600,000
2	San Lucero	900,000	1,300,000	4,800,000
3	Aguasol	650,000	900,000	3,200,000
4	Tres Cerros	480,000	650,000	2,400,000

Valdoria, its cities, and all data are fictional, created for practice. Rank-size rule: city number n should have 1/n the population of the largest.

Class directions: label each part, and write Describe and Explain parts as T1- (your reason in general words), E2- (the specific proof), A3- (why it matters).

A. Identify the zone in Stimulus 1 where most of Puerto Alba's squatter settlements are located. IDENTIFY

B. Using Stimulus 1, describe the spine and the elite residential sector in Puerto Alba. DESCRIBE

T1-

E2-

A3-

C. Explain ONE reason why wealthy residents of many Latin American cities live near the CBD and along the spine, unlike in many U.S. cities. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

D. **Using Stimulus 2, explain whether Puerto Alba is a primate city. Support your answer with data from the table.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

E. **Explain ONE cause of the rapid growth of squatter settlements on the edges of large cities in developing countries.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

F. **Using both stimuli, explain ONE challenge a primate city like Puerto Alba faces in providing services such as clean water, sanitation, or transportation to the periférico.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

G. **Explain ONE way a city government could improve living conditions in informal settlements like those in Puerto Alba's periférico.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-